ICC limited-overs tournament, the 2013 ICC Champions Trophy tournament in England. We were by now standing at No. 1 in the ODI world rankings. We were playing well and, as we completed our preparations in Amsterdam, we dared to hope again.

We worked hard, we spoke about being mentally strong, we thought we were doing everything right ... and we were disappointed again. Nothing clicked. We lost a warm-up match against Pakistan, and then lost our first match in Group B against India in Cardiff before beating Pakistan in Birmingham. Our fate would be determined by the result of our third and last group match, against the West Indies in Cardiff and, at the end of a nervous day spoiled by rain, the match was tied and we qualified for the last four with a greater net run rate. At last, after cursing their names so many times, Duckworth and Lewis finally felt like friends. Maybe our luck was changing.

A semifinal against hosts England at The Oval loomed and, in the pre-match press conference, I spoke about the opportunity to perform in a big match and to banish our reputation.

We were unfortunate to lose the important toss on a humid morning when both teams would have bowled first, but there were no excuses for our batting. Poor shot followed poor shot, and we crumbled to 80 for eight in the 23rd over. The contest was essentially decided well before lunch and, even though David Miller's fighting 56 helped us to post an almost-respectable total of 175, England cruised to an easy win.

As captain, I felt responsible and I felt sad ... sad for players who had desperately wanted to do well, sad for the people at home whose hopes had been raised again and been dashed again, and particularly sad for Gary Kirsten, our coach, who had decided not to accept an offer to extend his contract for two more years.

Gary's reputation as a coach extends across the cricketing world and is based on his special ability to bring out the best in anyone, to motivate and inspire. He is bold and innovative and, having guided us through